

Individual Entrepreneur Pitching Event Reflection #4

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Location: The BASE, HKUST Entrepreneurship Center

1. WHAT

At this stage of my entrepreneurial learning journey, I am still navigating between curiosity and commitment. I have several ideas that I find meaningful, yet I often struggle to translate them into structured and executable plans. My main challenge is not creativity, but clarity. I find it difficult to articulate how an idea evolves into a viable, investable venture.

During the pitching session held on March 30, 2026 at HKUST Entrepreneurship Center, I observed founders presenting projects in robotics and AI-driven life narrative platforms. What stood out to me was the discipline and structure of their pitches. Rather than focusing only on technological innovation, they presented clear development timelines, commercialization pathways, cost structures, competitive positioning, and investment highlights.

For example, one founder outlined milestones from early-stage research to projected commercial expansion through 2026. He described patent development, product iteration, cost reduction, and confirmed purchase orders. The presentation was grounded in measurable progress. This made the project feel executable rather than aspirational.

I realized that I often think about entrepreneurship at the level of ideas, while investors evaluate ventures at the level of systems, risks, and scalability.

2. SO WHAT

This experience reshaped how I interpret entrepreneurship. Before attending the event, I implicitly believed that originality and passion were the most critical factors in venture creation. However, observing the pitch reframed my understanding: funding is fundamentally about risk communication and execution credibility.

I noticed that when founders presented concrete data—cost ratios, projected revenue, signed agreements—the atmosphere in the room shifted. Specificity generated trust. The pitch was not an attempt to impress; it was an effort to reduce uncertainty in the minds of potential stakeholders.

This insight matters to me because it highlights a gap in my current approach. I tend to

delay structuring financial projections or validation steps because my ideas feel “too early.” Yet avoiding structure also prevents progress. The event helped me see that clarity is not the final stage of entrepreneurship; it is a prerequisite for it.

3. NOW WHAT

Moving forward, I intend to apply three specific actions to my own entrepreneurial exploration.

First, I will develop a concrete roadmap that outlines stages of validation, resource requirements, and measurable milestones. Second, I will construct a preliminary cost and revenue model, even if assumptions are imperfect. This exercise will force me to think operationally rather than abstractly. Third, I will practice delivering a concise three-minute pitch that addresses problem definition, market need, defensibility, and scalability.

I will evaluate whether this learning is effective by testing my ability to explain my idea clearly and confidently to peers who are unfamiliar with it. If I can respond to critical questions about feasibility and risk without hesitation, I will know that I have progressed.

This pitching event did not provide immediate solutions, but it provided a clearer benchmark for entrepreneurial readiness. That clarity represents meaningful growth in my learning journey.



Figure 1: Scenes from the Cross-University Innovation & Startup Pitching Session at HKUST Entrepreneurship Center (March 30, 2026).